4TH ANNUAL UCMERCED M2M MERCED TO MARKET

Date:
April 16, 2026

Time:
10:00am - 4:00pm

Location:
Dr. Vikram and Priya Lakireddy Grand Ballroom

9:30 am - 10:00 am — **Registration**

10:00 am - 10:30 am — **Opening Remarks**

- Chancellor of the University of California Merced, Dr. Juan Sánchez Muñoz
- Vice Chancellor for Research, Innovation, and Economic Development, Dr. Gillian Wilson

10:30 am - 12:00 pm — **UC Merced Innovators Showcase**

Join us at the Innovators Showcase at Merced to Market (M2M) to explore cutting-edge technologies and breakthrough research developed by UC Merced innovators. This dynamic session showcases UC Merced inventors sharing their technology's value propositions and potential commercial pathways and collaboration opportunities. Whether you are an industry partner, investor, entrepreneur, or ecosystem builder, the Innovators Showcase offers a unique opportunity to connect with innovators and discover technologies ready for commercialization and real-world impact.

12:00 pm - 1:00 pm — **Networking Lunch**

1:00 pm - 2:00 pm — **Bridging Academic Innovation and Industry: Understanding Industry Needs**

Join leaders from industry at Merced to Market (M2M) to connect, collaborate, and explore pathways for translating research into real-world impact. This session will provide insight into how industry partners evaluate early-stage technologies, what they look for in potential collaborations, and practical strategies for positioning your innovation for successful partnership and commercialization.

2:00 pm - 3:00 pm — **Local Resources for Research Partnerships, Startups & Tech Commercialization**

Grow strong roots, then scale. Anchored in the Central Valley's tradition of resilience and stewardship, this power hour gives you a practical playbook - the right contacts, programs, and next steps - to put down the strong roots that innovations need: pilot access, non-dilutive funding, advanced facilities, and investor-ready positioning. Built for UC Merced faculty seeking industry sponsors and for companies and investors scouting high-potential technologies, the session delivers immediate, actionable value so you can deepen partnerships locally and branch out to market faster, with fewer barriers.

3:00 pm - 4:00 pm — **Closing Reception**

UCMERCED Office of Technology, Innovation, and Industry Relations

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